in Kampuchea (now again Cambodia) where, between 1975 and 1979, the Khmer Rouge under Pol Pot murdered between one and a half to two million people (nearly a quarter of the country's population) for ideological purposes.

It is a deeply chilling thought that in terms of human suffering, none of these appalling events even come close to what would have happened if the Cuban missile crisis had resulted in all-out thermonuclear war.

In October 1962 humankind was very lucky.

Will we be so lucky next time?